Operation Zugzwang — Scenario Schedule

You are expected to arrive at the LLAB having read, and knowing, everything in your read-ahead: this handbook, the Scenario Brief, the Player Forms, and your team's documents. Your team's documents are secret, so don't show them to the other team.

All countries, people, and events in this scenario are fictional. All military systems are real U.S. systems, described with unclassified, approximate capabilities.

It is helpful to think of this document as an extension of the Matrix Wargame — Player Rules Handbook document with scenario-specific information.

1. Phases

1.1 Full Schedule

Time	Min	Block	What you do
1345–1403	18	**Phase I – Planning**	Organize your team, synthesize your pre-read intel, and build a plan. • **1345–1357 (min 0–12):** Plan & write up to **4 requests** (RFIs/RFFs). **Submit slips at 1357.** • **1357–1400 (min 12–15):** Finalize & rehearse your five-paragraph OPORD brief. • **1400–1403 (min 15–18):** Brief your plan and up to 3 planned COAs to your logger (§2.3).
1403–1405	2	**Kickoff inject**	The white cell announces that the war has begun and hands back Phase I RFI answers and RFF rulings.
1405–1505	60	**Phase II – Turns 1–4**	Four 15-minute turns: **Turn 1** (1405–1420) · **Turn 2** (1420–1435) · **Turn 3** (1435–1450) · **Turn 4** (1450–1505)
1505–1512	7	**Debrief 1**	Led by your Phase I–II flight commander. **The Phase III flight commander takes over afterward.**

1512–1520	8	**Phase III – Handover, & FRAGO**	Phase IV planning under the new flight commander. • **1519–1520 (last 1 min):** New flight commander gives a **1-minute oral FRAGO** (updated intent + up to 2 new planned COAs) to the logger (§2.4).
1520–1605	45	**Phase IV – Turns 5–7**	Three 15-minute turns (**Turn 5** 1520–1535 · **Turn 6** 1535–1550 · **Turn 7** 1550–1605).
1605–1612	7	**End of game & Debrief 2**	White cell scores objectives; Phase III flight commander leads Debrief 2.

1.2 Summary of Phases

Phase	Turns	What happens
Phase I – Planning	none	Synthesize pre-read intel, plan, and file up to 4 requests (due at minute 12). End by briefing your plan to your logger. **No COAs.**
Kickoff inject	—	The lead adjudicator announces the war has begun and returns Phase I request answers.
Phase II	Turns 1–4	Full turns
Phase III	—	Debrief 1, command handover to Phase III-IV flight commander, and a 1-minute oral FRAGO brief to your logger (§2.4).
Phase IV	Turns 5–7	Full turns

Each turn is about 3 days, so 7 turns cover about 3 weeks of conflict. The white cell keeps timelines realistic: moving forces 8,000 miles takes turns, not minutes (Scenario Brief §7).

1.3 Phase I – Planning

- You receive your intelligence products and team documents at least 24 hours before the LLAB so you can read them in advance. During Phase I (18 minutes), decide how your team is organized, synthesize your intelligence, build a plan, and file requests to posture your forces before the war starts.

- **Requests:** up to **4 in total** (RFIs and RFFs combined), **handed in at minute 12 (1357)** so the white cell can answer them while loggers hear the Phase I briefs. The white cell hands back answers and rulings after the kickoff inject, before Turn 1. Phase I RFFs follow normal arrival timing (Scenario Brief §7), counted from Turn 1.
- **The brief.** In the last 3 minutes (minutes 15–18), give an **oral brief** of your plan to your own logger, organized like a **five-paragraph OPORD**: Situation, Mission, Execution, Sustainment, Command & Signal. Use the template in the Player Forms. Nothing written is required.
- **Planned COAs.** The brief may name **up to 3 planned COAs** in order for Phase II, e.g. "Turn 1: X; Turn 2: Y; Turn 3: Z." The logger writes them down. When you later execute a planned COA *substantially as briefed, and the situation still supports it*, you get **+1 (Planned)**. If events make it invalid (the target is gone, you lost the assets, or the enemy forced a reaction), the bonus is lost. Recognizing that and adapting is the point.
- **Organize your team.** Only your flight commander is assigned. The team decides everything else, for example who runs operations, intel, logistics, and requests, and who briefs COAs and Cons. Rotate briefers so everyone talks.

1.4 Phase III: Command Handover and FRAGO

- **Command handover and FRAGO.** After Debrief 1, the **Phase III-IV flight commander** takes command. The new flight commander gives a **1-minute oral Fragmentary Order (FRAGO)** to the team's logger: a brief situation update, updated Commander's Intent, and **up to 2 new planned COAs for Phase IV (Turns 5–7)**, which earn the same **+1 (Planned)** bonus when executed as briefed.